

The HVAC AI-Visibility Checklist

The 7 signals AI checks before it recommends a contractor — and where most HVAC companies fall short

From GetKnownAI

It's 2pm on the hottest day of the year. A homeowner's AC just quit. Five years ago they'd have Googled "AC repair near me." Today a lot of them open ChatGPT and ask, *"Who's the best HVAC company near me for an emergency repair?"* — and the AI hands back three names and a number.

If you're one of the three, your phone rings. If you're not, you never knew the call existed. Right now, AI assistants name only a tiny fraction of local contractors — most companies are simply invisible at the exact moment someone's ready to book.

Here's the part most owners get wrong: being great at HVAC has almost nothing to do with it. AI doesn't judge your work — it judges what it can **read, trust, and verify** about you online. Below are the seven signals it weighs, and where most HVAC companies quietly fall short. Use this to find your gaps.

Start here: the 60-second invisibility test

Open ChatGPT (and Google's AI answers, and Perplexity if you want) and ask what a real customer would ask, using your actual city:

- "Best HVAC company in [your city]"
- "Who should I call for emergency AC repair in [your city]?"
- "Is [your company name] any good?"

Read the answers like a customer. Are you named at all? Is the info right? Who *is* getting named? Write it down — that's your starting line. Now go through the seven and mark where you're strong and where you're not.

The 7 signals (and the common mistakes)

1. Your pages answer the question — fast. AI pulls clean answers from pages that state the answer up front. *Where most fall short:* HVAC sites open with "Welcome to our family-owned

comfort experts..." — nothing an AI can lift. The fix is real content that answers what a customer actually asks, but the trap is doing it generically; it has to match how people phrase things in your market.

2. Structured data (schema). This is invisible code that tells AI what your business is, where, your hours, your services. The majority of sources AI cites include it. *Where most fall short:* either they don't have it, or — far more common — it's installed wrong or incomplete, so it looks done but does nothing. This is the single most botched item on the list.

3. Your Google Business Profile. AI leans heavily on Google Business Profile data for "near me" answers. *Where most fall short:* half-filled profiles, missing services, wrong service area, stale hours. Small fields, big impact — and almost everyone leaves points on the table here.

4. Reviews — recent ones. AI treats reviews as trust signals, and recency matters as much as volume. *Where most fall short:* a pile of old reviews and no system to keep new ones coming. A steady drip beats a one-time push.

5. Consistency across the web. AI cross-checks your name, address, phone and hours everywhere they appear. *Where most fall short:* the Google profile says one thing, an old directory says another, and the AI gets confused and drops you. Mismatches you forgot about are quietly costing you.

6. Named, credible information. AI is cautious about who it recommends, so it rewards verifiable credibility. *Where most fall short:* "our team of experts" instead of a named owner, real licenses, certifications, and years in business stated plainly.

7. Helpful, current content. AI favors useful, recent pages it can cite. *Where most fall short:* a site that hasn't been touched in two years, with no honest answers to the questions customers actually ask.

Where to start

Take your 60-second test and the seven above, and find your two or three biggest gaps. For most HVAC companies they're **schema (#2), the Google Business Profile (#3), and reviews (#4)** — but "most" isn't you, which is the whole point: the right starting move depends on what's actually broken for *your* company.

And here's the honest truth the quick wins don't tell you: getting *one* signal right is easy. Being the company AI consistently recommends means getting the *right* ones right, in the right order, done

correctly (especially the technical ones), and kept current as these tools change every few months. That's not a weekend — it's a system you run.

Rather have it handled for you? This checklist shows you where your gaps are. Closing them the right way — the schema done correctly, the Google Business Profile dialed in, the content AI can actually read — takes time most owners don't have. So we also do it *for* you: a one-time, done-for-you **AI Visibility Setup** that gets your company set up to be found and recommended across ChatGPT, Gemini and Google's AI answers, without you touching the technical side.

Want to see where you stand first? Just reply to the email that sent you this checklist with your company name, city, and website, and we'll personally check what AI says about your business — no charge.

— GetKnownAI